

# The Ultimate Boulder ADU Permit Cheat Sheet

Boulder, Colorado — 2026

## **For Informational Purposes Only:**

The information provided is strictly for educational purposes and does not constitute legal, architectural, or professional urban planning advice. Always consult the official city planning department before making any decisions or starting any construction project.

By using this guide, you agree that the publisher is not liable for any errors, omissions, or damages.

## ■ Boulder ADU — Key Regulations & Local Contacts

### Basic Zoning Rules

| Regulation        | Requirement          |
|-------------------|----------------------|
| Maximum Size      | 1,200 sq ft          |
| Property Setbacks | 5 ft rear, 5 ft side |
| Extra Parking     | Required (1 space)   |
| Owner Occupancy   | Required             |

### ■ Local Planning Department

**Department:** Planning & Development Services

**Phone:** (303) 441-1880

**Email:** [planning@bouldercolorado.gov](mailto:planning@bouldercolorado.gov)

**Address:** 1739 Broadway, Boulder, CO 80302

**Hours:** Check website

### ■ Key Links

- **Permit Application:** <https://bouldercolorado.gov/permits>
- **Zoning Map:** <https://bouldercolorado.gov/gis>
- **City Website:** <https://bouldercolorado.gov>

### ■ Estimated Fees

- Permit fee: \$400-1,800
- Impact fees: \$1,000-3,500
- Plan check: \$250-750

## ■ Boulder ADU — Project Checklist

- Verify zoning compliance — confirm your property is zoned for ADU
- Check lot size, setbacks, and height restrictions on the zoning map
- Prepare preliminary site plan and floor plan (can be hand-drawn)
- Complete the building permit application form
- Gather required documents: site plan, floor plan, elevations, title report
- Submit application package to the Planning Department
- Pay plan check and permit fees
- Wait for plan review (typically 4-8 weeks)
- Address any correction notices from the reviewer
- Receive approved permit
- Schedule inspections during construction (foundation, framing, electrical, final)
- Obtain certificate of occupancy upon completion

■ *Tip: Contact the local planning department early in your process — they can save you months of back-and-forth by identifying issues upfront.*